



PHOTO BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

Growth Driver
Sandeep Bakhshi,
MD & CEO, ICICI Bank

drivers identified by the lender that constitute its strategy of taking its entire bouquet of products to consumers. A customer-centric strategy, with a focus on ecosystems, internal cross-functional co-operation, external partnerships, process decongestion and operational flexibility, and integrating technology and digital across organisations are the other five value drivers.

As the saying goes, the proof is in the pudding. And the Mumbai-headquartered bank has climbed the ladder of BT500—the definitive listing of India's most valuable companies by average market capitalisation—leaving behind giants like HUL and Infosys, who rule their domains, to No. 4, climbing two places from last year. Undoubtedly, the credit entirely goes to the leadership.

When Bakhshi entered the corner office in October 2018, the bank had a lot on its plate, including the departure of MD & CEO Chanda Kochhar due to a conflict of interest in granting loans to Videocon, and a decline in the quality of assets in the corporate book. Since then, the bank's advances have nearly doubled from ₹5.12 lakh crore in March 2018 to ₹10.19 lakh crore in March 2023, while its assets have expanded from ₹8.79 lakh crore to ₹15.84 lakh crore. The robust growth in lending books has come with reduced non-performing assets (NPAs). Gross NPAs have plunged from 8.84 per cent to 2.80 per cent in the period, while net NPAs have plunged from 4.77 per cent to 0.48 per cent in the past six years. "Our strategic focus continues to be on growing our core operating profit through a 360-degree customer-centric approach and by serving opportunities across ecosystems and

A SNAPSHOT OF BANKS

➤ ICICI Bank enjoys the highest price-to-book valuation among large banks in India ➤ But public sector bank SBI is far ahead of private banks in terms of return on equity

Banks	Rank 2023/2022	Average m-cap* (₹ crore)	Total income (₹ crore)	PAT (₹ crore)	ROE (%)	P/BV Multiple
HDFC Bank	3/3	9,68,605 (19.4%)	2,04,666 (22%)	46,149 (21%)	17.2	2.73
ICICI Bank	4/6	6,39,027 (19.9%)	1,86,179 (18.2%)	34,463 (33.7%)	17.7	2.84
State Bank of India	7/8	5,11,869 (15.5%)	4,73,378 (16.3%)	56,558 (55.6%)	18.4	1.37
Kotak Mahindra Bank	12/12	3,64,320 (-1.1%)	68,142 (16.1%)	14,780 (23.9%)	14.2	2.92
Axis Bank	17/25	2,80,517 (25.8%)	1,06,155 (23.3%)	10,853 (-23.4%)	8.8	2.16

NOTE DATA AS OF NOVEMBER 17, 2023; *FROM OCTOBER 1, 2022, TO SEPTEMBER 30, 2023; TOTAL INCOME, PAT AND ROE FOR FY23; P/BV: PRICE TO BOOK VALUE; FIGURES IN BRACKETS INDICATE CHANGE IN PER CENT YOY; RESULTS ARE ON A CONSOLIDATED BASIS **SOURCE** ACE EQUITY